

Mirrored sun-catchers tap sunlight, say no to bulb

Sunlight has an effect of upheaval for all, and the dull winter mornings steal much of that thrust. Apparently, now with a new simple technology, people will be able to tap sunlight into their homes, by way of mirrored sun-catchers.

A simple installation, the sun-catcher, or a mirrored device reflects sunlight into houses. British designer Lucy Norman's 'Sun Sill' fabricates sunlight using windowsill-mounted mirrors to bounce in short supply of sunlight into the dark interiors. The technology is a boost to people who cannot afford electricity or light bulbs.

Just like a computer-controlled thermostat, Sun Sill's mirrors are controlled via a smartphone application that tracks the user's location and automatically determines the best position for the mirrors to catch sunlight into the same spot all day. The phone app is an optional choice and the sils can be moved manually.

Now a vending machine for 3D printers

Mechanical engineering graduates at the University of Idaho in the town of Moscow have come up with a new vending machine for 3D printers. SkyForge makes use of a 3D printer to sell plastic items that are only limited by the imagination of its users.

A limited access to their university's 3D printers is what prompted them to go ahead and start a company, Element Robot, and then build their own machine. They then placed the machine in the university's centrally located chemistry lab so anyone could retrieve printed items at their beck and call (paying some money of course!). It is fun because you will have a couple of students walk by and they will see it



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operating. They get drawn in and they get stuck watching it. The invention is already garnering more than 100 users with approximately another two signing up to use the machine every hour, claims Element Robot.

SkyForge prints items up to the size of a basketball by squirting layers of polylactic acid (PLA) plastic onto a glass plate heated to 437 degrees. Users can upload designs they want to Element Robot's website.

A GPS-based system that tracks how far your e-mail has travelled

Jonah Brucker-Cohen, a design lecturer has developed a free and open source plug-in for standard e-mail software such as Apple's Mail and Gmail that basically calculates the number of miles an e-mail has travelled before reaching an inbox. 'E-mail Miles' makes use of GPS technology and Internet tracking to determine where a message initially originated from and where it was received. The technology then calculates the total distance between the two and displays it on the screen alongside a map.

The system does its time and distance calculations using the Internet and a coordinated mapping system. When all of the mileage amounts are tallied, it adds them and provides the user with a map, the countries, continents and miles the e-mail travelled.

E-mail Miles scans outgoing e-mails and their destination servers for their geolocation. It then calculates the distance in miles, countries and continents the mail has travelled and tags each incoming e-mail with this info.

Timesaver—a new iOS time-tracking app

TimeSaver is a time-tracking utility for iPad, iPod and iPhone, which keeps track of all of your various projects and endeavours and provides you with statistical feedback on how much time you have spent on any particular project, when you last worked, and even provides a graph so you can see your progress over time.

This app tracks time for any amount of subjects, displays a 'stats' page for details on progress, provides a progress chart to see your progress, sends study reminders via local notifications, tweets